

Civic Issues in Jharkhand – Research & Problem Analysis

Background

Local governments in Jharkhand, like in many Indian states, face persistent challenges in resolving civic issues such as potholes, uncollected garbage, poor street lighting, waterlogging, and illegal dumping. Citizens often encounter these issues daily, but the absence of effective, accessible, and transparent reporting mechanisms limits municipal responsiveness. The Government of Jharkhand requires an innovative, mobile-first, and scalable solution that directly connects citizens with administrative authorities for faster redressal.

Current Scenario in Jharkhand

A review of civic reports and citizen feedback in Jharkhand indicates recurring pain points:

- Overflowing garbage bins and poor waste collection schedules in Ranchi, Jamshedpur, and Dhanbad.
- Potholes and deteriorating roads leading to frequent accidents and traffic congestion.
- Waterlogging during monsoon due to inadequate drainage infrastructure.
- Non-functional or broken streetlights contributing to unsafe public spaces.
- Lack of accountability in municipal departments and slow grievance redressal.
- Limited awareness among citizens about existing complaint mechanisms.

Gaps in Existing Solutions

- National-level platforms like the Swachhata App exist but have low adoption in Jharkhand.
- Lack of integration with local Urban Local Bodies (ULBs).
- Poor feedback loop – citizens rarely get updates about their complaints.
- Limited use of location data and images in complaint validation.
- No analytics framework for identifying high-priority civic hotspots.

Proposed Solution

To address these challenges, we propose a 'Crowdsourced Civic Issue Reporting and Resolution System' for Jharkhand. This platform will feature:

- A **mobile-first citizen app** enabling photo-based, geo-tagged issue reporting with text/voice notes.
- An **administrative web dashboard** for municipal staff to view, filter, and act on reports in real-time.
- Automated **routing of complaints** to the correct department based on category and location.
- Transparent **status tracking and notifications** for citizens.
- Analytics and heatmaps to identify high-density issue zones and measure departmental performance.
- Multilingual support for accessibility across Jharkhand.

Expected Impact

- Faster grievance redressal leading to improved citizen satisfaction.
- Cleaner and greener cities in alignment with the SIH 2025 'Clean & Green Technology' theme.
- Data-driven planning for infrastructure improvements.
- Strengthened trust between government bodies and citizens.
- Replicable model that can be scaled across other Indian states.

Conclusion

The proposed system aligns with the Smart India Hackathon problem statement and the Government of Jharkhand's requirements. It bridges the gap between citizens and local authorities by leveraging mobile technology, automation, and analytics for civic issue reporting and resolution. By deploying this solution, Jharkhand can significantly enhance civic engagement, accountability, and the cleanliness and sustainability of its urban and rural environments.